

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear equations in two variables	Easy

Question

Line k is defined by $y = 6x + 4$. Line j is parallel to line k in the xy -plane and passes through the point $(0, 5)$. Which equation defines line j ?

Answer

- A. $y = 6x + 5$
- B. $y = -5x + 5$
- C. $y = -6x + 5$
- D. $y = 5x + 5$

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is correct. An equation that defines a line in the xy -plane can be written as $y = mx + b$, where m is the slope of the line and $(0, b)$ is its y -intercept. It's given that line k is defined by the equation $y = 6x + 4$; therefore, the slope of line k is 6 . Since line j is parallel to line k in the xy -plane and parallel lines have equal slopes, it follows that the slope of line j is 6 . It's also given that line j passes through the point $(0, 5)$, which is its y -intercept. Substituting 6 for m and 5 for b in the equation $y = mx + b$ yields $y = 6x + 5$. Therefore, the equation $y = 6x + 5$ defines line j .

Choice B is incorrect. This equation defines a line that has a slope of -5 , not 6 .

Choice C is incorrect. This equation defines a line that has a slope of -6 , not 6 .

Choice D is incorrect. This equation defines a line that has a slope of 5 , not 6 .